

a 24x7 entity. You can do banking when it is convenient to you, not bound by the 10 a.m. to 2 p.m. working hours of your bank branch. The average Indian household in top 10 cities pays around 42 bills annually. If you spend 30 minutes and Rs 20 on fuel on paying each bill, you are spending almost one full day and Rs 1,000 every year on paying bills. With Net banking you save a neat bundle and lots of time. Says Maninder Juneja, head-retail liabilities, ICICI Bank, "The number of transactions happening through non-branch channels has increased from 20 per cent to 86 per cent in the past four-five years."

FROM CHAOS TO CONTROL IN YOUR FINANCIAL LIFE

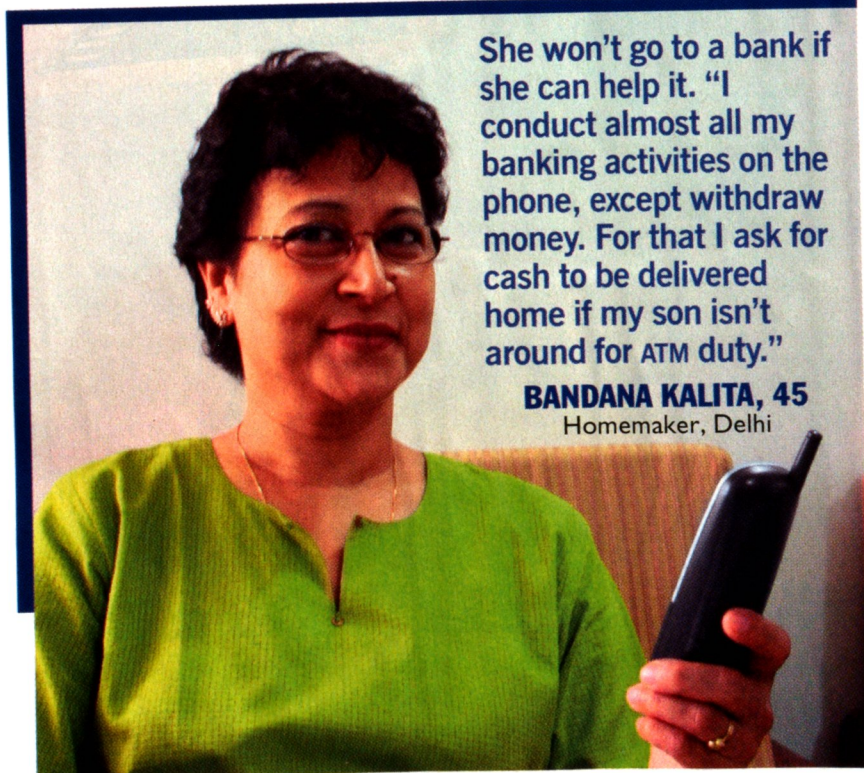
The real time nature of Net or phone banking allows people to seize investment opportunities just as they emerge. Though financial planners advise mutual fund investors not to try and time the markets, it doesn't hurt to pour in some money into your

equity mutual fund when markets tank. Last fortnight presented such an opportunity when the markets crashed by about 10 per cent in two-three trading sessions. Anybody who had an online mutual fund account linked to his Net banking account could have just logged on and invested in a fund. Sure, such an investment could have also been done offline but how many people carry cheque books to office? Risk averse? How about buying some gold online when the price is really low?

COMING SOON: BANKING IN YOUR POCKET

Despite all these advantages of convenience, speed and savings, less than 10 per cent of approximately 47 million bank customers in India have subscribed to Net banking. The biggest hurdle before home banking in India is the low penetration of computers and the Internet. There are just 17.70 Net-enabled computers per 1,000 population in the country. Though it is not as dynamic as Net

ROHIT GUPTA



She won't go to a bank if she can help it. "I conduct almost all my banking activities on the phone, except withdraw money. For that I ask for cash to be delivered home if my son isn't around for ATM duty."

BANDANA KALITA, 45
Homemaker, Delhi

Online Banking

No longer limited to offering the same old banking services as available in a branch, Internet banking is integrating every aspect of your financial life into one single window.



BASIC BANKING

- Check account balance
- Check credit card transactions
- Transfer funds
- Get one screen view of your banking relations with multiple financial providers

MAILBOX

- Leave standing instructions
- Contact the branch manager for redressal of grievances
- Apply for new services like account opening

VALUE ADDITION

- Cheque book/DD requests
- Smart money order
- TDS enquiry
- Demat services
- Forex transactions

INVESTMENTS

- Transact in mutual funds
- Buy insurance policies
- Trade in stocks
- Buy gold

LOAN PRODUCTS

- Apply for a loan
- Manage your existing loans by tracking fluctuations in interest rates and EMIs
- Compare products to bag the best deal and service

